



STEVEN DOUGLAS CORP.

BRAND GUIDE

Engineering Excellence. Trusted Partnerships.

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01 OUR BRAND

Engineering Excellence. Trusted Partnerships.

Founded 1998 · Concord, NE Ohio

WHO WE ARE

Steven Douglas Corp. (SDC) is a second-generation family-owned custom automation engineering company. Since 1998, we have delivered 1,500+ projects across automotive, life sciences, electronics, aerospace, energy, and consumer products.

WHAT WE BUILD

New custom machines from \$500K–\$2M. Small-part, high-speed assembly. We are NOT a repair shop or modification house. Our sweet spot is production-critical, engineered-to-order automation.

OUR PROMISE

Automation built to perform — and backed by the people who built it. We do not just build machines — we become a trusted extension of our customers' engineering teams.

02 LOGO SYSTEM



PRIMARY — BLUE

Light/white backgrounds



LOGO MARK — BLUE

Secondary/space-limited use

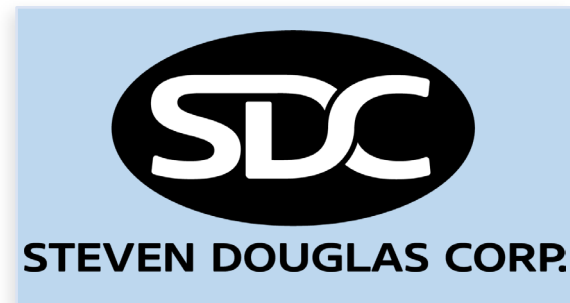


WHITE

Dark/colored backgrounds

LOGO FILES

- SDC_Logo_Blue_PNG.png — Primary blue logo · use on light backgrounds
- SDC_Oval_Logo_Blue.png — Logo mark only · secondary/favicon use
- SDC_Logo_w_Tagline_White.png — White reverse + tagline · dark backgrounds
- SDC_Black_Logo_PNG.png — Single-color/print applications
- SDC embroidery version available — Apparel and promotional items



BLACK

Light/colored or blue backgrounds

02 LOGO USAGE RULES

SAFE SPACE

Clear zone around all logo variants = height and width of two Os from DOUGLAS. Never crowd the logo or place other elements inside this zone.



✓ DO'S

- Use blue logo on light/white backgrounds
- Use white reverse logo on dark backgrounds
- Maintain safe space at all times
- Ensure the full logo is visible on photography
- Use logo mark (oval) when space is limited
- Use tagline version on formal external materials

✗ DON'TS

- Change logo colors
- Skew, stretch, or distort the logo
- Add drop shadows or textured backgrounds
- Place on a background that obscures visibility
- Rearrange or alter logo elements
- Use 'SDC Automation' as company name

03 PRODUCT LOGOS

SDC's pre-engineered product lines each carry their own sub-brand identity, always anchored by the SDC mark above the product name.

SDC
INDEXINGRING

Precision indexing dial systems

SDC
FLEXFEEDER

Vision-guided flex feeding

SDC
TRAYHANDLING

Automated tray load/unload systems

SDC
CHASSIS

Machine base & structural systems

04 COLOR PALETTE



PRIMARY BLUE

#1574C4

Primary brand color. CTAs, headlines, links, logo.



DARK NAVY

#061D39

Headers, dark backgrounds, anchor color.



LIGHT BLUE

#AACEE8

Supporting tints, backgrounds, icons.



YELLOW

#FFDE51

Accent, callouts, highlight bars.



GREEN

#74C415

Success stats, secondary CTAs.



LIME GREEN

#BEFA4F

Vibrant accent. Use sparingly.



GRAY

#D9D9D9

Dividers, backgrounds, rules.



BLACK

#231F20

Body text, knockout type.

05 TYPOGRAPHY

OFFICIAL BRAND FONT

Core Sans NR 63 / 53 EX Bold

All brand materials: letterhead, proposals, presentations, print collateral. All-caps for brand name and captions.

STEVEN DOUGLAS CORP.

WEB & SOCIAL

Montserrat Bold

Website headlines, social media graphics, HTML artifacts, digital banners. Closest web-safe match to Core Sans.

Engineering Excellence.

MICROSOFT OFFICE

Aptos 11pt

ALL Microsoft Office files — Word, Excel, PowerPoint — body text, tables, and default paragraphs. 11pt standard.

Trusted Partnerships Since 1998.

OUTLOOK EMAIL SIGNATURE

Century Gothic Bold 11pt Century Gothic 9pt

Based on email signature template.

Steven Douglas Corp.
7750 Discovery Lane, Concord Twp, OH 44077

06 VOICE & MESSAGING

"Whatever you do, SDC can help you do it better, faster, and more reliably."

HEARD & UNDERSTOOD

We reflect the customer's problem back before we talk about our solution. They should feel like we actually listened.

GENUINELY INVESTED

We actually enjoy this work. That comes through. Customers should feel like we're on their team, not selling to them.

QUIETLY CAPABLE

We let our work and our process do the talking. No chest-thumping — the track record speaks without us having to announce it.

A PARTNER, NOT A VENDOR

We're embedded in their production problem. The goal is a machine that works for their needs — and a relationship that lasts.

HOW WE TALK ABOUT OUR WORK

- Lead with the customer's world — their problem, their production line, their outcome
- Be specific when it matters, simple when it doesn't — no jargon for jargon's sake
- Talk about what they'll feel: reliability, speed, confidence — not features we're proud of
- Write the way we'd talk to someone across a table — warm, direct, no performance

07 DIGITAL & SOCIAL

WEBSITE | sdcautomation.com

Font: Montserrat Bold (headlines) · system sans-serif (body)

Colors: Primary Blue #1574C4 · Dark Navy #061D39 · Yellow accents

Logo: Blue logo on white/light sections · White logo on dark/blue sections

CTAs: Primary Blue fill · White text · Rounded corners

Photography: Industrial/shop floor · High contrast · No stock clichés

Tagline: Engineering Excellence. Trusted Partnerships. on all key pages

LINKEDIN — COMPANY + PERSONAL PAGES

Post schedule: Weekly - varies

Content mix: 60% Thought leadership · 30% Shop floor · 10% Culture

Voice: Open with the straight fact — no filler opener

Tags: Tag people by name · No closing questions on celebratory posts · Tag company in day-to-day business-related promotional type posts on personal pages

Length: Tighter than drafts. Punchy. Scannable on mobile

Hashtags: 3–5 targeted tags: #automation #manufacturing #robotics

Images: Real SDC shop floor photos · No generic stock · SDC-branded graphics

08 MICROSOFT OFFICE STANDARDS

W WORD

- Font: Aptos 11pt — body text, tables, headers
- Headings: Aptos Bold, size 14/12/11
- Logo: Blue logo upper-left on letterhead
- Colors: Primary Blue for headings & accents
- Footer: SDC address + contact line

X EXCEL

- Font: Aptos 11pt default for all cells
- Header rows: Dark Navy fill, White Aptos Bold text
- Accent rows: Light Blue #AACEE8 alternating fills
- Charts: SDC blue palette (#1574C4, #AACEE8, #061D39)
- No decorative images — keep data clean

P POWERPOINT

- Titles: Core Sans / Montserrat Bold
- Body: Aptos; slide content text
- Title slides: Dark Navy bg · White/Yellow text
- Content slides: White bg · Blue headings
- Logo: White on dark slides; Blue on light slides

USAGE QUICK REFERENCE

COMPANY NAME

Always: 'Steven Douglas Corp.' or 'SDC'
Never: 'SDC Automation' — not our company name.

TAGLINE

Engineering Excellence. Trusted Partnerships.
All formal external materials: proposals, presentations, email sigs.

LOGO SELECTION

Light bg → SDC_Logo_Blue_PNG.png
Dark bg → SDC_Logo_w_Tagline_White.png
Single-color/print → SDC_Black_Logo_PNG.png

EMAIL SIGNATURE

Name | Title
acohen@sdcautomation.com | 440-991-1071
www.sdcautomation.com | Steven Douglas Corp.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Real SDC shop floor, machines in action, team at work.
No generic stock photography. High contrast. Industrial aesthetic.

SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNTS & WEBSITE

@sdcautomation
www.sdcautomation.com

TRAINING AN AI AGENT TO SOUND LIKE SDC

01 SYSTEM PROMPT STARTER

Copy this into any AI tool as your starting context:

You are writing on behalf of Steven Douglas Corp. (SDC) www.sdcautomation.com — a family-owned custom automation engineering company in Concord, Ohio, founded in 1998. SDC has a strong regional presence with a global reach.

SDC builds new custom machines (\$500K–\$2M). Small-part, high-speed assembly. Not a repair shop.

The customer should always feel heard, understood, and confident SDC can deliver.

Tone: warm, direct, genuinely invested. A trusted colleague — not a vendor proving a point.

Never sound arrogant or blunt. Lead with the customer's world, not SDC's résumé.

Signature line:

"Whatever you do, SDC can help you do it better, faster, and more reliably."

02 WHAT GOOD OUTPUT SOUNDS LIKE

SOUNDS RIGHT

- ✓ Opens by acknowledging what the customer is trying to solve
- ✓ Mentions specific robot brands, industries, or outcomes when relevant
- ✓ Closes with a clear, direct next step — not a passive offer to help
- ✓ Feels like it was written by a person who genuinely cares about the result
- ✓ Short paragraphs — never walls of text

SOUNDS WRONG

- ✗ Credential drops: "25 years, 1,500+ machines" as an opener
- ✗ Filler openers: "Great question" / "Thanks for reaching out"
- ✗ Vague claims: "industry-leading," "world-class," "cutting-edge"
- ✗ Passive CTAs: "Feel free to reach out" / "Don't hesitate"
- ✗ Calls the company "SDC Automation" — it's Steven Douglas Corp. or SDC

03 PROMPTING TIPS

Always give it context first

Tell it who the customer is, what they make, and what they're trying to solve — before asking it to write anything.

Ask for the customer's perspective

"Write this as if you've just heard their problem and you genuinely want to help them solve it."

Correct it by example

Instead of "sound warmer," paste a line that's off and write the version you'd actually send. The AI will learn the gap.

Use the signature line as a gut check

If the output doesn't feel like it belongs in the same breath as "whatever you do, SDC can help you do it better, faster, and more reliably" — rewrite it.

Test it on a real inquiry

Paste in an actual inbound message and ask it to reply. That's the fastest way to find where the voice breaks down.



STEVEN DOUGLAS CORP.

HAPPY BRANDING!

Note: please contact the marketing team before creating new brand materials.
